DDD-P-56F
September 27, 1988
SUPERSEDING
DDD-P-56E
September 29, 1986

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAD, MATTRESS, POLYESTER BATTING, QUILTED, FLAT OR FITTED

This specification is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of mattress pads, one flat, the other fitted.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and sizes. Mattress pads shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I: Flat; quilted pad with binded edges, which covers the top portion of the mattress
Size 1: 36 by 75 inches
Size 2: 52 by 75 inches

Tolerance: Width ± 1.0 inch, length ± 1.0 inch

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 7210

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Type II: Fitted; quilted top pad to cover the mattress top and cloth skirt with elasticized edges to fit and cover the mattress sides (see 6.1)

Size 1: 29 by 76 by 9
Size 2: 36 by 74-1/2 by 9
Size 3: 36 by 78 by 9
Size 4: 36 by 84 by 9
Size 5: 38 by 74-1/2 by 9
Size 6: 39 by 78 by 9
~~Size 7: 36 by 74-1/2 by 9~~ 63 x 74 1/2 Exception to Size
Size 8: 36 by 79-1/2 by 9
Size 9: 38 by 79-1/2 by 9

Tolerance: Width -0, +1/2 inch, length -0, +1.0 inch

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Federal Specifications

V-T-285	- Thread, Polyester
V-T-295	- Thread, Nylon
CCC-C-430	- Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, and Polyester and Cotton
DDD-L-20	- Label: For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Federal Standards

FED-STD-123	- Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Commercial Item Description. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications

MIL-W-5664	- Webbing, Textile, Cotton Wrap
MIL-L-35078	- Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items, Clothing, Personal Equipment, and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-B-41826	- Batting, Synthetic Fibers: Polyester, (Unquilted and Quilted)
MIL-T-43548	- Thread, Polyester Core: Cotton, Rayon, or Polyester
MIL-T-44193	- Thread, Polyester, Textured

Military Standards

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	- Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731	- Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

Federal Regulations

Federal Trade Commission

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20580.)

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Consumer Product Safety Commission

FF-4-72 - Standard for the Flammability of Mattresses and Mattress Pads (16 CFR Part 1632)

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for the issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organization which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.4). Variation from this document may appear in the sample, in which case this document shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.3).

3.3 Flammability. All mattress pads shall meet the provisions of the Consumer Product Safety Commission Standard for the Flammability of Mattresses and Mattress Pads when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

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3.4 Material. (See 6.7).

3.4.1 Cloth. The cloth for the covers of the quilted polyester batting, type I bias cut binding and type II skirt shall be bleached white, polyester and cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1 or 2, style D, E, F, or G of CCC-C-430.

3.4.2 Polyester batting. Polyester batting conforming to type VII, class 8 batting of MIL-B-41826 may be used as the filler material, except that the thickness shall be not greater than 0.52 inch and the requirements for thickness after laundering, compressional recovery after laundering, and launderability shall not apply. The bonded polyester batting shall be furnished without any cloth outer covering. The use of commercial bonded polyester batting is acceptable, provided that the batting possesses a minimum weight of 3.6 ounces per square yard, a maximum thickness of 0.52 inch, and the batting is bonded with a uniformly applied approved durable bonding agent (see 6.6). Testing for thickness and weight shall be as specified in MIL-B-41826. The maximum concentration of the applied bonding agent shall not exceed 18.0 percent of the weight of the finished bonded batting. The bonding agent shall be applied to both sides of the batting filler.

3.4.3 Thread. The thread shall conform to type I or II, size A, subclass A of V-T-285 or as an alternate, the thread shall conform to MIL-T-43548, cotton or polyester covered, ticket sizes 70/2 and 50/2 for all stitch types. An additional thread alternate is permitted for all stitch types except 301, and shall conform to type II, class 1 of MIL-T-44193, 45 tex and 35 tex. All thread color shall be white.

3.4.4 Elastic. The elastic webbing for the skirt edges shall be one piece, white, conforming to type I, class 1, of MIL-W-5664. Alternatively, the elastic shall be one piece, white, flat, heat resistant, launderable, non-staining, treated rubber which has been compounded of natural rubber, synthetic rubber or a mixture thereof, and shall conform to the physical requirements shown in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

TABLE I. Physical requirements of alternate skirt edge elastic

Characteristics	Requirements
Color	White
Thickness, inches (± .002)	0.030
Width, in. (± 1/16)	1/4
Yield, yds./lb. (± 15%)	92
Modulus	100% elongation at 1.3 ± 0.2 lb. pull
Change in modulus after accelerated aging (over method) (%)	20.0 (max)

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3.5 Labels. Each mattress pad shall have an identification label and a state label attached to one end of the pad.

3.5.1 Identification label. The identification label shall conform to type VI, class 5 of DDD-L-20. An alternate label for the type II pad shall conform to type III, class 5 of DDD-L-20. The legend and size of characters in these labels shall be as specified below.

Legend	Size of character (inches), minimum
Nomenclature	1/8
Contract number	3/32
NSN	3/32
Textile Fiber Products Identification Act information	3/32
Manufacturer's name	3/32
Size	3/32

3.5.2 State label. The state label shall conform to the legal requirements of the state in which the mattress pads are manufactured.

3.6 Type II design. The design of the fitted mattress pad with quilted top and cloth skirt with elasticized edges is illustrated in figure 1.

3.7 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the requirements specified in tables II and III and herein. Figures 1 and 2 are furnished solely for guidance and information. Should variation from the document appear in figures 1 or 2 the document shall govern.

3.7.1 Stitches, seams, and stitching. All stitches, seams, and stitching shall conform to FED-STD-751. The type of seam, stitching, and stitches per inch shall be as specified in table II and III. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams sewn so that no raw edges, run-offs, pleats, puckers, or open seams occur. When two or more methods of seams or stitches are given for the same operation, any one may be used.

3.7.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1/2 inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams or stitching. Ends of a continuous line of stitching shall overlap not less than 1/2 inch. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be embedded in the materials sewn.

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3.7.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks, skipped stitches, run-offs, or bobbin runouts occur during sewing, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1 inch back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Except for prestitching, thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch in back of the defective area, continue over the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1 inch beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching (1/2 inch over each end for box, box-x, and W-W stitching). Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.7.1.2 Types 503, 504, 515, and 516 stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. All repairs shall be in accordance with 3.7.1.1.1a and b. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. Stitch types 503 and 504, which includes the overedge portions of stitch types 515 and 516, shall exhibit a width or bite of 3/8 inch ± 1/32 inch. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams sewn so that no raw edges, run-offs, twists, pleats, puckers, or open seams occur.

3.7.1.3 Bartacks. Unless otherwise specified, all bartacks shall be 1/4 to 1/2 inch long and 1/8 ± 1/32 inch wide, and shall contain 14 stitches. Bartacking shall be free from thread breaks and loose stitching.

3.7.1.4 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/4 inch.

3.7.2 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting, and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.3 shall be removed from production and replaced with nondefective material.

3.8 Manufacturing operations requirements. The mattress pads shall be manufactured in accordance with all operations specified in tables II and III. The contractor is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations.

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TABLE III. Type II manufacturing operations requirements

No.	Requirements	Stitch type	Seams and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread	
					Needle	Bobbin or looper
1.	Cutting.					
	a. The cover fabrics for the polyester batting shall be cut with no piecing seams on either face.					
	b. The length of the skirt fabric shall be cut to a length to fit the perimeter of the quilted pad dimensions including seam allowances. The skirt cloth may be cut as a single continuous piece or alternately it may be achieved with two length of fabric stitched together to satisfy the total length required.					
	c. The polyester batting shall be cut to fit the specific length and width dimensions of the pad size and shall be trimmed on all four sides.					
2.	Quilting.					
	a. Position polyester batting between two cover fabrics.	301	-	5-9	A	A
	b. Quilt the three layers together with one of the quilt patterns specified in figure 2, A, B, or C; zig-zag, criss-cross or dumbbell pattern within the specified dimensions.					

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TABLE III. Type II manufacturing operations requirements - Continued

No.	Requirements	Stitch type	Seams and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread: Needle	Thread: Bobbin or looper
3.	Skirt.					
	a. If the skirt length is achieved with two pieces, the pieces shall be spliced together by placing right sides together and stitching a vertical seam.	515 or 516	SSa-2	10-14	AA or 50/2 or 45 tex	A or 70/2 or 35 tex
	b. The total skirt length shall be closed by a seam created by placing the two skirt ends together and stitching.					
	c. The top of the skirt seam(s) shall be bartacked with the bartacked positioned so that it lies 3/8 inch ± 1/16 inch below the perpendicular seam created when the quilted pad and skirt are stitched together. The bartack shall straddle horizontally across the vertical seam. If the skirt seam(s) are located outside the elasticized portion of the skirt, then a bottom bartack is required 5/8 inch ± 1/16 inch above the bottom skirt edge and shall straddle horizontally across the vertical seam.					
4.	Attach elastic.					
	Elastic shall be attached to each width end of the mattress skirt such that it extends across the full width, around each corner and extending 12 inches down each length side. The elastic shall be metered on at a 1-1/2 to 1 ratio; such that the elastic covers 1-1/2 times its original relaxed length. Each elastic end shall be bartacked.	504 or 503	SSa-1	10-14	AA or 50/2 or 45 tex	A or 70/2 or 35 tex

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TABLE III. Type II manufacturing operations requirements - Continued

No.	Requirements	Stitch type	Seams and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread	
					Needle	Bobbin or looper
5.	Finished skirt edge.					
	The skirt length edges shall be finished with overedge stitching which can continue on from the elastic stitched edges.	504 or 503	SSa-1	10-14	AA or 50/2 or 45 tex	A or 70/2 or 35 tex
6.	Attach skirt to pad.					
	The upper edge of the skirt shall be placed right sides together with the together with the quilted pad and stitched together. The corners may be rounded.	515 or 516	SSa-2	10-14	AA or 50/2 or 45 tex	A or 70/2 or 35 tex
7.	Attach label.					
	The label will be attached to one of the width ends of the pad. Type IV label will be secured be the seam joining the skirt and pad together. Type III label shall be laminated to one of the skirt width ends.	515 or 516	SSa-2	10-14	AA or 50/2 or 45 tex	A or 70/2 or 35 tex
8.	Cleanliness.					
	a. Remove all spots and stains.					
	b. Trim all loose thread ends.					

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TABLE II. Type I manufacturing operations requirements

No.	Requirements	Stitch type	Seams and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread	
					Needle	Bobbin or looper
1.	Cutting.					
	a. The cover fabric shall be cut with no piecing seams on either face.					
	b. The binding shall be cut on the bias, not less than 1 9/16 inches wide.					
	c. The polyester batting shall be trimmed on all four sides.					
2.	Quilting.					
	a. Position polyester batting padding between two cover pieces.					
	b. Quilting shall be accomplished with either zig-zag or criss-cross (diamond) stitching as specified below.	301	–	5-9	A	A
	(1) Zig-zag. The horizontal distance between the parallel rows of stitches shall be 1 ± 1/16 inch. The length of the row of stitches in each direction before changing direction shall be 1 7/8 inches ± 1/8 inch (see figure 1 (A)).					

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TABLE II. Type I manufacturing operations requirements - Continued

No.	Requirements	Stitch type	Seams and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread	
					Needle	Bobbin or looper
2.	Quilting - Continued					
	(2) Criss-cross (diamond). The distance between the horizontal points shall be 2 inches ± 1/8 inch and the distance between the vertical points shall be 3 1/8 inches ± 1/8 inch; (i.e., the diamond shaped by criss-cross stitching shall measure 2 inches ± 1/8 inch parallel to the filling direction of the cloth). The stitching forming the sides of the diamond shall be 1 7/8 inches ± 1/8 inch (see figure 1 (B)).					
3.	Binding.					
	a. Bind the edges of the mattress pad with a continuous binding with the raw edges of the binding turned under and stitched 1/8 ± 1/16 inch from turned edge catching all raw edges in the stitching. The binding shall begin on the short side at a corner and continue around the pad, finishing not less than 6 inches beyond the starting end of the short side of pad.	301	BSc-1	6-10	A	A

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TABLE II. Type I manufacturing operations requirements - Continued

No.	Requirements	Stitch type	Seams and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread	
					Needle	Bobbin or looper
3.	Binding - Continued					
	b. The labels shall be centered, positioned adjacent to each other on one end of the pad with the top or bottom edges caught in the binding seam.	301	BSc-1	6-10	A	A
4.	Cleanness.					
	a. Remove all spots and stains.					
	b. Trim all loose thread ends.					

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3.9 Figure 2. Figure 2 specifies the dimensions of the quilt patterns for zig-zag in figure 1.A., criss-cross or diamond in figure 1.B. and dumbbell in figure 1.C. The zig-zag and criss-cross quilt patterns shall exhibit a symmetrical design.

3.10 Workmanship. The mattress pads shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification, and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirement in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.3 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document. In addition, when commercial polyester batting is used as filler materials for the pads, a contractor's certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirements listed below:

Component (commercial bonded polyester batting)	Requirement paragraph
Weight	3.4.2
Thickness	3.4.2
Approved bonding agent	3.4.2
Concentration of bonding agent	3.4.2

Upon request, the certificate of compliance shall be accompanied by actual test, inspection, or other verifiable data.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection of sub-assemblies shall be made to ascertain that construction details that cannot be examined in the finished product are in accordance with specified requirements. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance, any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of mattress pads. The sample unit shall be one mattress pad. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0 for major defects and 10.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Cloth (sheeting)	Any hole, cut, tear, mend, burn, or weak place	X	
	Objectionable or rancid odor	X	
	Cloth not as specified	X	
	Three or more contiguous broken or missing warp or filling threads	X	
	Two contiguous broken or missing warp or filling threads		X
	Loose or weakening slub		X
Cleanness	Any spot or stain, more than 1/4 inch square in area, clearly noticeable at a distance of 6 feet		X
Cover	Contains piecing seams on either face	X	
Quilting	Any thin place devoid of batting 2 inches square or more in area	X	
	Any thin place devoid of batting, more than 1 inch square in area, but less than 2 inches square in area		X
	Three or more thin places devoid of batting regardless of area	X	
	Any furrow, lump, or bulge resulting from uneven or improper distribution of the batting	X	
	Four or more untrimmed thread ends or loose threads, 1/4 inch or more in length		X
	Surface twisted, pleated, wavy, or puckered	X	
	Any pleat regardless of area, 8 inches or more in length and 1/4 inch or more in depth at widest point, or any pleat not within 5 inches from any edge extending more than 2 inches in length	X	
	Three or more pleats less than 8 inches in length and 1/4 inch or more in depth at widest point regardless of area per pad		X
	Needle chew	X	

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Quilting - continued	A run back of more than 1 inch of broken or missing stitches in the quilting	X	
	Any area evidencing complete bobbin change		X
	One or more rows of stitching omitted in quilting	X	
	Quilting dimensions not in accordance with table II		X
	NOTE: Row of stitches is any adjoining 1 7/8 inches ± 1/8 inch segment of either the zig-zag or criss-cross sewn pattern.		
	Stitches per inch:		
	Two or more stitches less than the number specified	X	
	One stitch more or less than the number specified		X
Binding	Not cut in bias direction	X	
	Width not as specified (may be determined prior to stitching)	X	
	Torn or chewed	X	
	Not one continuous length per pad		X
	Closing end extends less than 6 inches beyond the starting end		X
Seams and stitching	Binding not seamed with seam type BSc-1		X
	Not stitch type 301 throughout quilting and binding		X
	Stitching margin of binding less than 1/16 inch or more than 3/16 inch		X
	Binding seam does not begin at corner on short side of pad		X
	Binding sewn with less than 6 stitches per inch		X
	Binding sewn with more than 10 stitches per inch		X

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Seams and stitching continued	Any open seam or run-off more than 1 inch in length	X	
	Any open seam or run-off 1 inch or less in length		X
	Pad seam not sewn with stitch type 515 or 516	X	
	Bottom skirt edge not sewn with stitch type 503 or 504	X	
	Type II seams and stitching, except quilting, sewn with less than 10 stitches per inch		X
	Type II seams and stitching, except quilting, sewn with more than 14 stitches per inch		X
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches occur.		
	Edge of pad not securely caught in binding		X
	Edge of pad not fully inserted into binding after stitching		X
	Any raw edge of binding more than 1/2 inch in length		X
	Three or more raw edges of binding or skirt per pad up to and including 1/2 inch in length		X
	Raw edge of pad covering, over 2 inches in length		X
	Two or more raw edges of pad covering, up to and including 2 inches in length		X
	Any raw edge of the pad covering regardless of length, not caught in binding stitching	X	
	NOTE: This examination will be made by turning back the edge of the binding at the raw edge locale and determining visually whether the pad covering is caught in the binding stitches.		

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Seams and stitching continued	Stitch tension loose, resulting in a loosely secured seam or looped stitches		X
	Stitch tension tight, stitches break when normal strain is applied to the seam or stitching		X
NOTE:	Puckering is evidence of tight tension.		
Quilting stitching	More than 1 1/2 inches of broken or missing stitches in quilting	X	
Stitching ends	Ends of stitching not secured as specified (except when caught in other seams or stitching)		X
Thread breaks, skipped or run-off stitches (unless otherwise classified herein)	Overstitched less than 1 inch in each direction beyond the defective stitching area		X
NOTE:	Thread breaks, two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.		
Labels	Missing, misplaced, incomplete, incorrect, or illegible	X	
Skirt	Does not fit pad evenly, too small or too big	X	
	Total length made up with more than two lengths	X	
	Height dimension less than 9.0 inches		X
	Skirt seams not bartacked as specified	X	
	Bottom skirt edge not completely overedged		X

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TABLE IV. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Elastic	Does not extend across full width	X	
	Does not extend 12 inches down length sides		X
	Elastic ends not bartacked	X	
	Elastic not stitched with 503 or 504		X
	Elastic not completely overedged		X

4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. Each mattress pad examined for dimensions shall be laid in a flat position without tension. The length and width shall be the average of three measurements taken in each direction. Type II skirt height shall be measured at each corner and at the mid-section of each side length. Any average less or more than the specified length or width (including permitted tolerances) for the size required in 3.7 shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of mattress pads. The sample unit shall be one finished mattress pad. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.5 Flammability testing. Flammability tests shall be performed in accordance with all the provisions of FF-4-72 (16 CFR Part 1632). A contractor's certificate of compliance shall be furnished and will be accepted for the stated requirements. Certification shall include material details used to meet the standard.

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4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container Polyethylene bag heat-sealed seam open, noncontinuous or crooked; vent holes missing or greater than 1/4 inch diameter Incorrectly fabricated bag Alternate polyethylene bag not provided with tuck or reverse flap
Content	Number of polyethylene bag unit packs per shipping container is more or less than required

4.4.7 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Load not bonded as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Packaging shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pad shall be neatly folded to measure approximately 18 by 25 inches. The folded pad shall then be unit packed in a close-fitting flat or square style clear polyethylene film bag that is 0.00125 inch thick (± 20 percent tolerance). The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film, tubing, or sheeting. The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat-sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and to the formed edges of the bag. A 1/4-inch maximum diameter hole shall be made at any two corners of each polyethylene bag to allow the excess air to escape. The bag shall be closed by means of a heat seal or pressure-sensitive tape. Closure shall be made as close as possible to the open end. Prior to or during the closure operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled. As an alternative, the polyethylene bag may be of the tuck in or reverse flap type, in which a heat seal closure and corner vent hole are not required.

5.1.2 Commercial. Each pad shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Pads, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style OSC-L (minimum 3-inch overlap), grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c, of PPP-B-636. The number of pads per box and the box dimensions shall be as specified in table V. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Pads, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style OSC-L (minimum 3-inch overlap), type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The number of pads per box and the box dimensions shall be as specified in table V. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

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TABLE V. Packaging of mattress pads

Item	Number per box	Inside dimensions Length	Width	Depth	Pallet pattern
Type I, size 1	18	25-1/2	18-1/2	27	90
Type I, size 2	12	25-1/2	18-1/2	27	90
Type II, size 1	6	19	14-1/2	12	95
Type II, size 7	6	19-1/2	19-1/2	18	90
Type II sizes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9	6	21	20	12	90

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Pads, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), pads packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be number 90 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.4.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.4.2.1 Polyethylene bagged packages. Polyethylene bagged unit packs shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit easy identification.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The mattress pads are intended for use on beds by military and nonmilitary agencies for the protection of mattresses. The type II pad is intended in lieu of the combined use of a mattress cover per DDD-C-628 and the type I pad specified in this document.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type and size required (see 1.2.1).
c. When a first article sample is required (see 3.2, 4.3, and 6.3).
d. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
f. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
g. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Sample. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.5 Civil agency packaging. When level B packaging requirements are specified for civil agency procurements, the requirements in 5.1.1 shall apply.

6.6 Bonding agents. Approval of bonding agents for use in battings covered by this specification is the responsibility of the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014. Approval is based on more extensive evaluations, including those of toxicity, which are not set forth in the specification. Because of the time necessary to conduct full evaluation, only those bonding agents already approved and so listed in the invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be considered acceptable for the related procurement.

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6.6.1 Submittal for approval. Request for approval should be submitted to the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, attention of STSNL-VT. It should be accompanied by approximately 5 square yards of a minimum of 2 ounces per square yard polyester batting manufactured with the proposed bonding agent together with applicable test data. Information is to be furnished regarding the commercial designation and chemical description of the bonding agent. (Approved lists will indicate only the commercial designation.) Chemical identification with products already approved should be made, if applicable, and any available data on skin irritancy or toxicity should be submitted. If applicable, a statement should be included that as used the resin is well cured and that no materials with known high toxicity are used prior to cure.

6.7 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this document (see 3.4).

6.8 Subject term (key word) listing.

Bedding
Mattress
Pad, mattress

6.9 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review Activities

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 82

User Activity

Navy - MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY

Army - GL

Project No. 7210-0280

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